

# RAJESH DAMMALA

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

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Application SRE & Operations leader with 16+ years safeguarding production systems, preventing incidents, and driving operational excellence in high-availability environments. Proven track record as situation manager during critical incidents — driving rapid resolution, post-incident learning, and root cause prevention. Deep expertise in Azure, observability platforms, application telemetry, and building automation/self-healing capabilities that eliminate recurring failures. Combines strong technical breadth (.NET, SQL, PowerShell, cloud-native) with leadership ambition to build high-performing service reliability teams.

## CORE COMPETENCIES

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Application SRE & Service Reliability • Incident Situation Management • Problem Management & Root Cause Prevention • Observability & APM (Azure Monitor, Datadog) • Auto-Detection & Self-Healing • Application Telemetry & Performance • High-Availability Operations (24x7) • Cross-Functional Collaboration • SLAs / SLOs / Error Budgets • Automation & Orchestration • Team Leadership & Mentoring • Critical Thinking Under Pressure

## SELECTED IMPACT

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- % Drove operational efficiency from 85% to 98% through preventative methods, auto-detection, and systematic risk hardening across 20+ production applications
- % Architected AI-driven auto-detect and recovery platform achieving 30-35% automated incident resolution — reducing manual intervention across the outage lifecycle
- % Reduced mean time to resolve by 32% acting as situation manager — driving resolution, coordinating L1/L2/L3 teams, and ensuring post-incident learning
- % Eliminated 25,000+ recurring incidents through data-driven problem management — identifying patterns, driving systemic fixes, and preventing recurrence
- % Authored 175+ operational playbooks establishing application telemetry standards, alerting thresholds, and auto-recovery procedures
- % Maintained 100% SLA compliance across globally distributed high-transactional-volume production services

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Lead Escalations Manager — Xbox CXT SRE | May 2021 – Present

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra) — Redmond, WA

- Own stability, performance, and operational integrity of 20+ critical applications in production — high-transactional-volume services supporting millions of users
- Act as situation manager during high-priority incidents: drive resolution, coordinate cross-functional teams (dev, eng, ops, infra), ensure post-incident learning
- Proactively identify and address risks — hardened infrastructure and applications through systematic vulnerability elimination and auto-recovery implementation
- Drive adoption of SRE and application telemetry principles: Azure AppInsights, KQL dashboards, alerting, monitoring, and performance metrics across teams
- Built auto-detect and recovery capabilities (Azure SRE AI Agent) — 30-35% of incidents resolved autonomously without human intervention
- Guide implementation of automation and self-healing capabilities reducing manual effort across detection, triage, and remediation
- Collaborate with engineering teams to define monitoring, alerting, capacity, and performance standards — optimising observability across the ecosystem
- Apply strong problem-solving and critical-thinking under pressure — relentless pursuit of root cause prevention over simple resolution

### Azure Support Technical Lead — Customer Support Services | Nov 2016 – May 2021

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) — Redmond, WA

- Led team of 15 engineers resolving L2 incidents and working closely with L1/L3 support teams across Azure platform
- Hands-on incident response and problem management — decisive action, calm under pressure, cross-functional collaboration
- Supported application performance management (APM) and troubleshooting across enterprise Azure environments
- Drove operational resilience improvements through automation, monitoring enhancements, and performance engineering

### Operations Lead — Azure LiveSite Operations | May 2012 – Nov 2016

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) — Hyderabad, India | Redmond, WA

- Led globally distributed team of 32 engineers — built high-performing service reliability team from ground up
- Solid technical background spanning application development and infrastructure operations at Azure scale

- Built PowerShell automation saving thousands of hours — auto-detection, alerting, and self-healing for infrastructure health
- Experience with networking fundamentals, cloud-native technologies, monitoring, and capacity management
- Mentored engineering teams on incident response, operational resilience, and performance optimization

### **Systems Analyst / Data Center Engineer | Sep 2009 – Nov 2011**

*IBM (via Infosoft Inc) — Hammond, IN*

- Infrastructure operations: server builds, cluster configuration, networking, high-transactional-volume system maintenance

### **EDUCATION**

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Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Science — JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

### **TECHNICAL SKILLS**

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Cloud & Infrastructure: Azure (AppInsights, Monitor, Logic Apps, KeyVault, AD), Networking, Cloud-Native Technologies

Observability & APM: Azure Monitor, Kusto/KQL, Power BI, Grafana, ServiceNow, Application Telemetry

Automation: PowerShell, Python, Azure Logic Apps, Auto-Detection & Self-Healing, Infrastructure as Code

Development: .NET ecosystem, SQL Server, CI/CD Pipelines (ADO), Git, Performance Engineering

Frameworks: SRE Principles, SLAs/SLOs/Error Budgets, ITIL, Incident/Problem/Change Management, DevOps

Certifications: Microsoft Certified (Azure 70-533, 70-534), AZ-900 Azure Fundamentals